



Pernod Ricard

2024/25 MENTORSHIP PROGRAMME

CLOSE-OUT REPORT

15 AUGUST 2025



**NATIONAL MENTORSHIP
MOVEMENT**

Mentorship - the Power of Two

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BACKGROUND

In March 2022 Pernod Ricard (PR) in partnership with National Mentorship Movement (NMM) launched a pilot mentorship programme as part of its Sustainability and Responsibility programme to give back to the community. The approach encompassed one-on-one mentorship with eight PR executives mentoring eight entrepreneurs in Alexander Township (Alex) over a twelve-month period. In addition, individual mentors hosted group workshops during which they shared their expertise with the collective.

In 2023/24 Pernod Ricard implemented a second programme under the PRSA Foundation, in partnership with NMM and Alex Biz. This programme was 6-months in duration, and matched PR executives as mentors in one-on-one mentorship relationships with to Alex Biz entrepreneurs, with an additional group mentorship element.

The current FY 2024/25 programme continued to grow in impact, facilitating partnerships for 25 Pernod Ricard mentors, including involvement from Executive members of the team (namely, Pamela, Ben and Sola), and 25 mentees from AlexBiz and other townships including Soweto and Kagiso. The programme also opened group mentorship sessions to the PRSA Foundation Makers entrepreneurs who gained value from the engagements, all in line with the intention of the programme to grow entrepreneurs in SA.

In this document, we provide the following:

- Overview
- Impact
- Lessons learned.

OVERVIEW OF THE 2024/25 MENTORSHIP PROGRAMME

OBJECTIVES

The objectives were the following:

- Build on the lessons learned and experience from the past two programmes
- Continue to support Pernod Ricard's drive to be a purpose driven organisation, by providing an opportunity for their employees to inculcate the mindset of giving back to the community while developing new skills as mentors
- Support entrepreneurs to grow their businesses within specific areas of need that correspond to the skill sets of Pernod Ricard mentors.

SCOPE

The scope of the programme was as follows:

- 25 Pernod Ricard employees who volunteered to mentor young entrepreneurs
- 25 entrepreneurs mainly from Alexandra township whom we selected as mentees
- Monthly one-on-one mentorship sessions
- Monthly group mentorship sessions, each hosted by a member of the mentor team.

APPROACH

Project Set-up

- Due to our previous successful partnership, we again partnered with Thabiso Sebata of Alex Biz to mobilise mentees from his growing network of entrepreneurs in Alexandra Township. Alexandra being so near to the Woodmead offices meant that in-person meetings and workshops were feasible for all parties.
- We also approached additional partner organisations within and outside of Alex to increase our mobilization efforts, including: AlexFM, SafeHub Alex, Ikamvalethu, Bokamoso Youth Centre, and Galaxcoc. Word of mouth and encouragement from former mentees in the programme also helped us to increase the numbers of mentees who applied for this year's cohort.
- NMM then prepared our online platform to register and match mentorship pairs, track attendance, and send out surveys.
- We set up a project team of Roslyn Solomon (Project Director), Claire Gemmill (Project Manager) and Neo Moloi (RAPA - Relationship Agent and Project Assistant) from NMM, Kalashni Narainsamy and Lerato Mashale from Pernod Ricard and Thabiso Sebata, from AlexBiz,
- We sent out a mentor appeal to the Pernod Ricard employees and then collaborated with Thabiso to mobilise mentees who submitted a written motivation for the first-round elimination and then a short video for final selection by the Pernod Ricard volunteer mentors. The PR and NMM team then completed a manual matching exercise, to ensure that mentors and mentees were appropriately matched.
- To ensure the programme was accessible to all, Pernod Ricard organized a shuttle service to and from Alexandra for all mentees to attend the group sessions, as well as Uber trips for those outside Alex.

Onboarding

- We put in place 25 one-on-one mentorship partnerships scheduled to run for six months - please see Appendix – 1. Mentorship Partnerships.
- NMM held training sessions on 14 & 15 January 2025 to onboard mentors and orientate them on the programme. We provided an overview of the programme structure and duration, the mentor and mentee roles and responsibilities, managing their individual and group mentorship sessions in line with the NMM mentorship approach and philosophy, and answered any questions that the mentors had. We also provided the mentors with a Mentor Field Guide, with activities and structure to support them in conducting their mentorship journey with their mentees.
- We onboarded the mentees at the launch with their engaging with the mentors in interactive group sessions (as shown below in the Launch Programme). We facilitated training to share their role as a mentee and check any assumptions they had about the mentorship process. We emphasised that it is their responsibility to contact their mentor and schedule their meetings, and the importance of setting and working towards goals for their mentorship journey.

Launch

The in-person launch took place on 28 January 2025 at the Pernod Ricard SA Foundation. It provided an orientation for the mentors and mentees, addressing their roles and expectations and the mentorship journey ahead. It also enabled partners to meet for the first time, and to have their first meeting during lunch. Please see Appendix – 2. Launch Event Programme for the programme of the day.

Programme implementation

One-on-One mentorship

Throughout the programme, NMM tracked participation and ensured that all participants had access to Neo, the designated NMM RAPA (Relationship Agent and Project Assistant). Neo made weekly calls to participants to check-in on the partnerships and identify any concerns or challenges. We also put in place a WhatsApp group for the mentees, where the project team sent regular communication and reminders to attend meetings, share group workshop invitations, and complete surveys. Goal setting and achievement is a key element of the programme. Please see Appendix – 3. Mentee goals and progress with achieving them and Appendix - 4. Mentor comment on progress towards achieving the goals.

Group mentorship

To give all the mentees an opportunity to benefit from the inputs of all the mentors, Pernod Ricard hosted a series of 1.5 hour group mentorship sessions at the PRSA Foundation. The following mentors facilitated the sessions on the dates below:

- Ruvimbo Mandonga on Revenue Management – 25 February 2025
- Thuli Nthuli on Procurement – 8 April 2025
- Sandy Muller on HR & Payroll – 6 May 2025
- Shivani Maharaj on Problem Solving & Value Streams – 24 June 2025
- Humphrey Mvula on Marriage & Goals – 25 July 2025

IMPACT

Throughout the programme, NMM kept in touch with the participants and tracked the health of the programme via the following:

- Surveys, both from the NMM platform (kick-off, one-month, three months and close-out surveys) and telephone surveys on an individual basis.
- The mentee WhatsApp group. Although it was intended to provide a way for the NMM and Pernod Ricard project teams to communicate with mentees, it also became a source of feedback on the programme as the mentees continually shared their learnings and feedback with each other.
- Mentee group sessions, where mentees gathered at the Pernod Ricard SA Foundation to engage in a 1.5 hour group mentorship workshop. This enabled the Ops team to check in on the mentees and the ongoing growth and developments of their business and mentorship partnerships. From the mentees' feedback, the Ops team was able to provide further support when partnerships needed it.

MENTOR SURVEY FEEDBACK

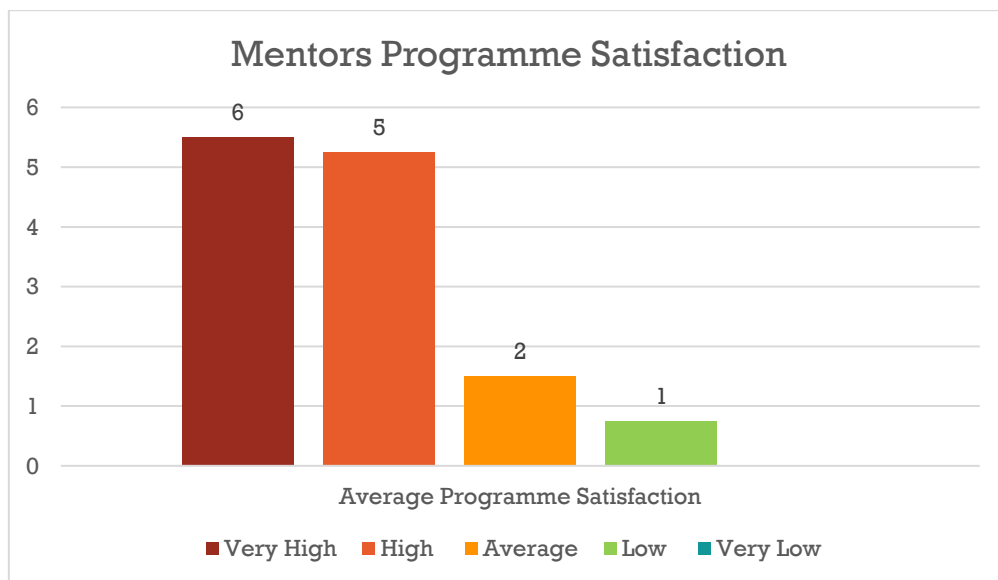
In this section, we present the following survey results for the mentors:

- Match satisfaction
- Programme satisfaction
- Willingness to recommend the programme
- Impact on the mentors.

For the first three, the graphs show the average results for the four surveys we carried out as well as a table of the individual surveys.

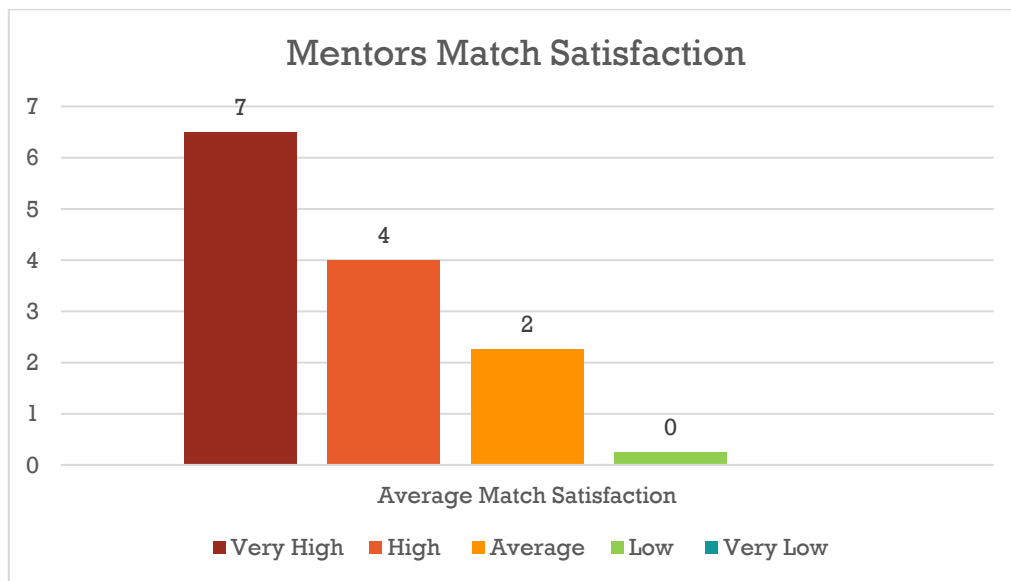
In all cases, the overwhelming majority rated their satisfaction with the programme and their matches and their likelihood of recommending the programme as high and very high.

Programme satisfaction



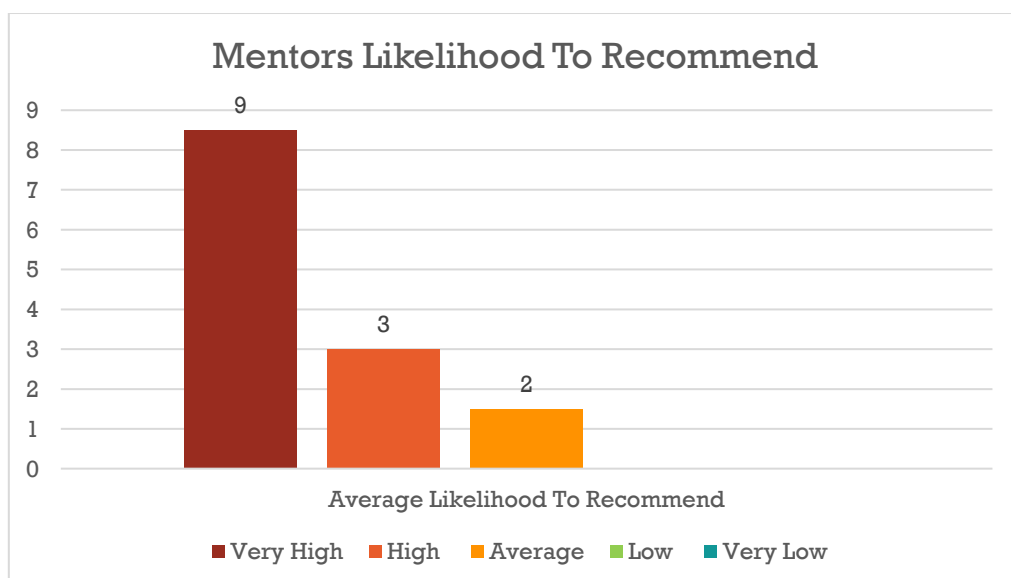
Programme satisfaction	Very High	High	Average	Low	Very Low	TOTAL
Kick-Off	6	6	1	2	0	15
One-Month	3	5	2	1	0	11
Three-Month	5	5	3	0	0	13
Close-Out	8	5	0	0	0	13
Average	6	5	2	1	0	13

Match satisfaction



Match Satisfaction	Very High	High	Average	Low	Very Low	TOTAL
Kick-Off	8	5	2	0	0	15
One-Month	5	3	2	1	0	11
Three-Month	6	3	4	0	0	13
Close-Out	7	5	1	0	0	13
Average	7	4	2	0	0	13

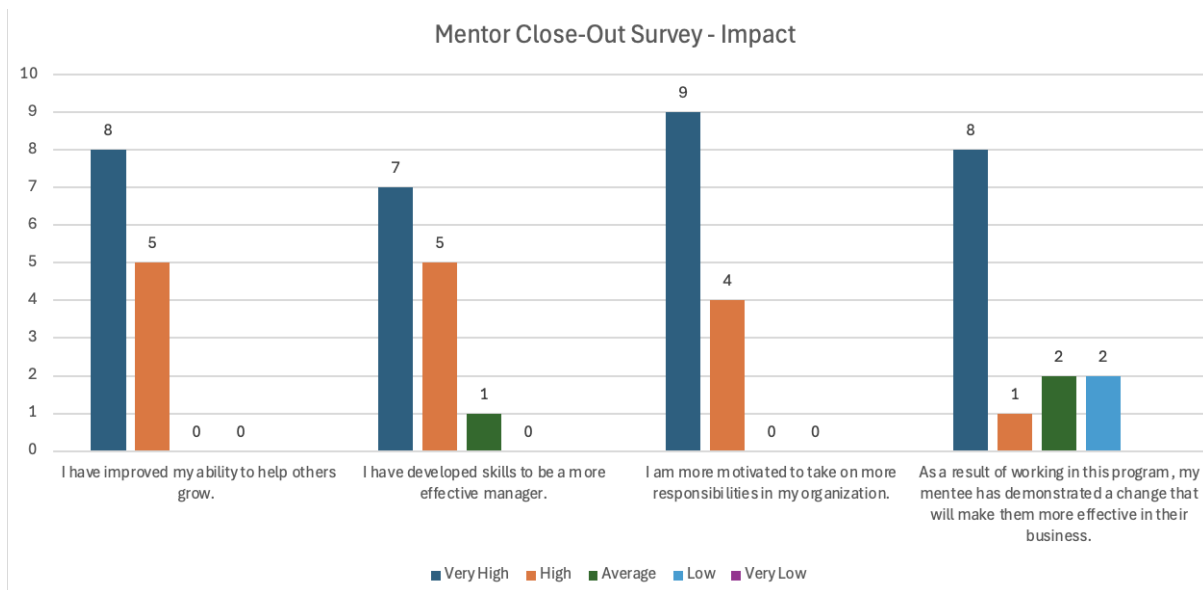
Likelihood of recommending the programme



Likely to Recommend	Very High	High	Average	Low	Very Low	TOTAL
Kick-Off	10	4	1	0	0	15
One-Month	6	2	3	0	0	11
Three-Month	9	2	2	0	0	13
Close-Out	9	4	0	0	0	13
Average	9	3	2	0	0	13

Impact on the mentors

At the end, we asked the mentors the extent to which the programme had impacted on them in the following four areas:

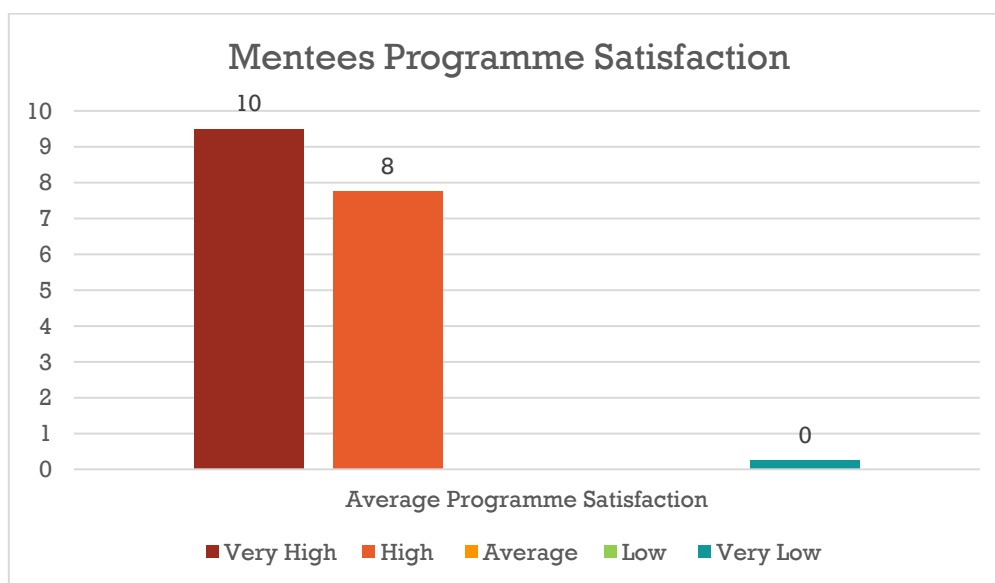


It is clear that the vast majority of mentors believe that the programme had a significant impact on them.

MENTEE SURVEY FEEDBACK

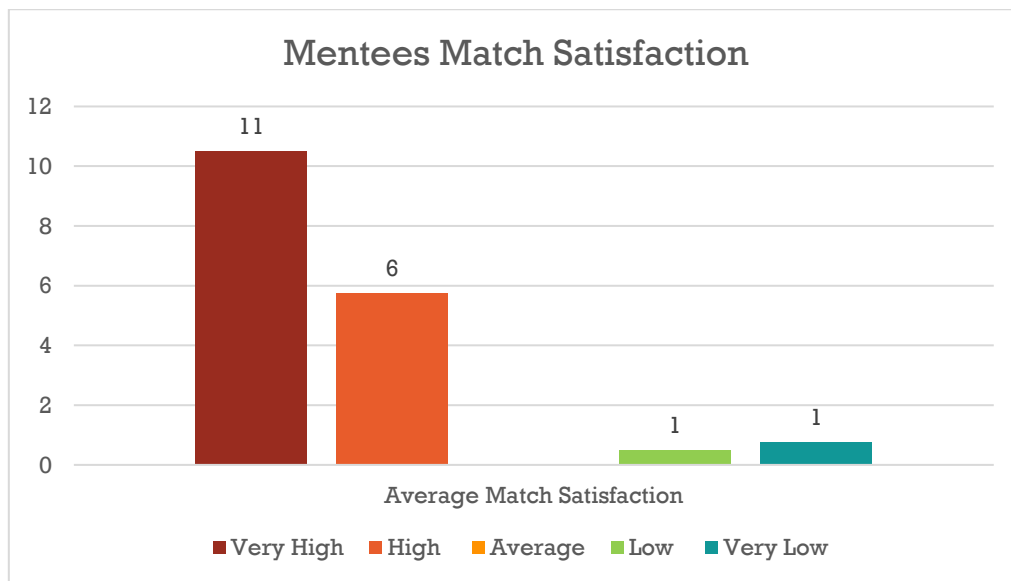
We carried out similar surveys to the ones we carried out for the mentors with similar results. The overwhelming majority rated their satisfaction with the programme and their matches and their likelihood of recommending the programme as high and very high.

Programme satisfaction



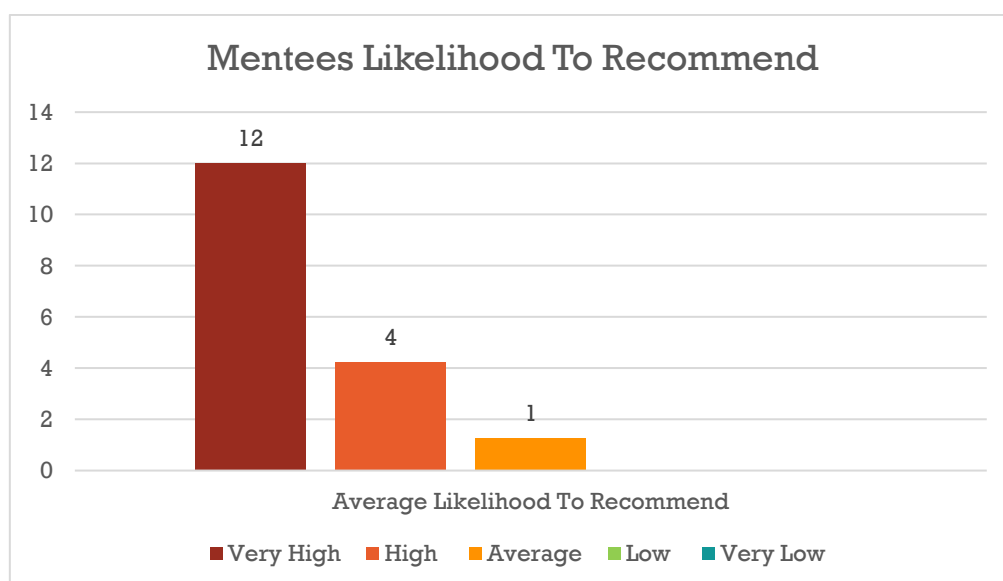
Programme satisfaction	Very High	High	Average	Low	Very Low	TOTAL
Kick-Off	10	8	0	0	0	18
One-Month	10	10	0	0	0	20
Three-Month	7	8	0	0	0	15
Close-Out	11	5	0	0	1	17
Average	10	8	0	0	0	18

Match satisfaction



Match Satisfaction	Very High	High	Average	Low	Very Low	TOTAL
Kick-Off	14	4	0	0	0	18
One-Month	14	6	0	0	0	20
Three-Month	7	6	0	1	1	15
Close-Out	7	7	0	1	2	17
Average	11	6	0	1	1	18

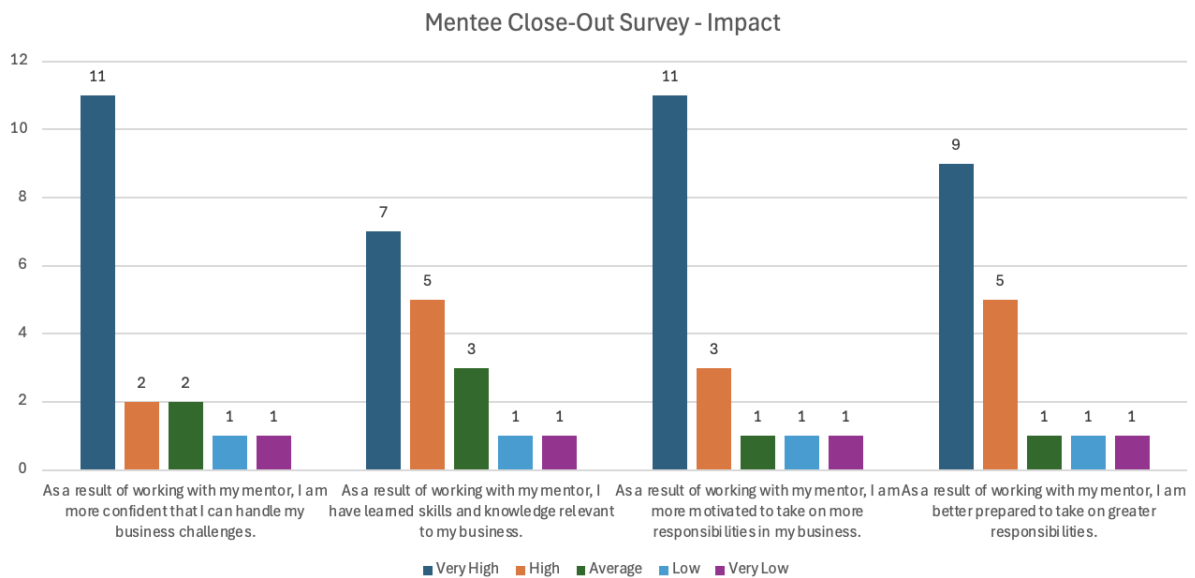
Likelihood of recommending the programme



Likely to Recommend	Very High	High	Average	Low	Very Low	TOTAL
Kick-Off	14	4	0	0	0	18
One-Month	16	4	0	0	0	20
Three-Month	11	3	1	0	0	15
Close-Out	7	6	4	0	0	17
Average	12	4	1	0	0	18

Impact on the mentees

We asked mentees to rate the extent to which working with a mentor had impacted on them in the following four areas:



The vast majority of mentees indicated that working with their mentors had had a significant impact on them.

WHATSAPP GROUP FEEDBACK

We established a WhatsApp group to keep in close contact with the mentees, from an operational perspective and to allow them to engage, support and learn from one another. As per our experience in previous programmes, this proved to be a successful method of engaging the mentees and deepening the learning and impact of the programme. We also included Operational team members in the WhatsApp group, including Claire Gemmill, Neo Moloi, Lerato Mashale, as well as Executive members of Pernod Ricard, including Pamela Nkuna and Kalashni Narainsamy, to track the progress and engagements of the mentees.

GROUP SESSION FEEDBACK

We asked mentees how helpful the group sessions had been, and the majority of those who responded found the sessions highly helpful, both practically in applying the knowledge they gained to their business, and personally in their entrepreneurial development.

Mentees who responded expressed appreciation for the level of PRSA mentor involvement and the opportunity to learn alongside their fellow mentees. Their feedback is summarized in the table below:

Impact	No. of Mentees	Feedback
Improved Business Knowledge & Understanding	12	Mentees reported that the group sessions deepened their understanding of business operations, systems, finance, and conflict resolution
Practical Skills & Implementation	7	Mentees reported learning actionable skills that they could apply to their business, ie. payroll, financial literacy, HR, operations
Entrepreneurial Growth	5	Mentees reported on personal development and mindset shifts, such as confidence in business decisions, and the importance of investing time in self
Value of Mentors' Support	4	Mentees appreciated the content and knowledge shared, as well as the personal involvement of the mentors in their growth
Missed Sessions, but Positive Impression	4	Mentees reported that although they missed some group sessions, the ones they could attend were valuable
Peer Learning & Networking	3	Mentees reported on the learnings they gained from one another, which sparked motivation through shared challenges and progress

The full comments from the mentees can be found in the Appendix – 5. Group session feedback: overall.

Revenue management

On 25 February, Ruvimbo Mandonga facilitated a group mentorship session on Revenue Management. Mentees who attended shared feedback that reflected a strong satisfaction with the content Ruvi shared and her overall mentorship. Some of the key themes from the mentees' feedback included:

- High value and relevance of content – mentees found the revenue management session highly informative, insightful and engaging. Mentees appreciated Ruvi's expertise and how she was able to explain the topic and breakdown the concepts.
- Deepened understanding – mentees learned the importance of considering multiple factors when it comes to pricing and revenue decisions (ie. value-based pricing strategies, package deals, production costs and time investment, target audience, competition, tracking revenue growth)
- Practical takeaways – mentees learned to track all income and expenses and apply the framework of Ruvi's 5 pillars (pricing, offerings, product/mixing, promotion, discounts)
- Motivation and Mindset – mentees gained a shared sense of unity through the session and deepened their entrepreneurial mindset

The full comments of the mentees who gave feedback on Ruvi's session can be found in the Appendix – 6. Group session feedback: revenue management.

Procurement

On 8 April, Thuli Nthuli facilitated a group mentorship session on Procurement. Mentees who attended gave highly positive and appreciative feedback, and valued Thuli's session as insightful, practical, and relevant to their businesses. Through Thuli's session, mentees improved their understanding of procurement, compliance, and documentation, and felt more confident and equipped to apply this knowledge to improve their businesses. Some of the key themes from their feedback included:

- Increased understanding of procurement processes – mentees learned what procurement entails for both product and service based businesses
- Importance of compliance and documentation – mentees gained knowledge on the role of compliance documents in contracts, non-disclosure agreements and how these protect the business
- Practical takeaways – mentees learned about VAT when it comes to pricing and vendors, and Thuli shared some examples of the challenges that can happen when the procurement process is not followed
- Relevance of topic – mentees gained an understanding of how procurement is connected to other business functions such as HR, payroll and revenue management

The full comments of the mentees who gave feedback on Thuli's session can be found in the Appendix – 7. Group session feedback: procurement.

HR & payroll

On 6 May, Sandy Muller facilitated a group session on HR & Payroll. Mentees were appreciative of Sandy's commitment to their learning and gave positive feedback that the session was engaging, insightful, and easy to understand. They valued both the practical HR and payroll knowledge and the personal insights they gained as entrepreneurs. Some key themes from their feedback included:

- Business Mindset – mentees learned the importance of investing in employees and how this contributes to building a strong brand and company culture
- Ability to apply practical knowledge – mentees were able to adapt the content from larger businesses to their small local businesses
- Mentor's passion and commitment – mentees appreciated Sandy's enthusiasm and how she simplified HR and payroll concepts

The full comments of mentees who gave feedback on Sandy's session can be found in the Appendix – 8. Group session feedback: HR & payroll.

Problem solving & value chain mapping

On 24 June, Shivani Maharaj facilitated a workshop on Problem Solving & Value Chain Mapping. Mentees who attended gave highly positive feedback, reporting that they felt motivated, inspired and creatively energized by the session. They valued the practical problem-solving tools that Shivani had shared and appreciated how the concepts connected to what they have been learning on their mentorship journey. Some key themes from their feedback included:

- Inspiration and creativity – mentees reported that Shivani's approach to problem solving was innovative and sparked new ideas
- Unity in shared learning – mentees experienced a strong sense of connection and collaboration in the way Shivani facilitated the session and had mentees think through the problem solving models together to find solutions to their business's challenges
- Application and integration – mentees could connect the learnings from previous group sessions to the tools Shivani shared, including the "why-why-why" framework
- Preparation for future challenges – mentees left feeling equipped with skills to take on not only the challenges in their businesses, but also in their personal lives

Shivani's session left such a powerful impact on the mentees, that she offered to facilitate a follow-up session online. Eight mentees attended online, alongside the PRSA Makers, who participated in the session and gained further insights and tools for their businesses.

The full comments of mentees who gave feedback on Shivani's session can be found in the Appendix – 9. Group Session Feedback: problem solving & value chain mapping.

Marriage & goals

On 25 July, Humphrey Mvula and special guest, Lance Stehr, shared a group session on Marriage & Goals as a metaphor for an entrepreneur's commitment to their business and the vision. Mentees who attended reported that the session was deeply motivational and reflective, and that they left feeling inspired and impacted emotionally. Mentees appreciated the powerful lessons Humphrey and Lance shared on resilience, goal setting, commitment and investing in themselves and their businesses. Some key themes from their feedback included:

- Resilience and embracing failure – mentees learned that failure is part of the process and were encouraged (by the facilitators and each other) to take risks and persist
- Goal setting and vision – Mentees clarified their goals and defined their vision, and learned the importance of goals in directing their effort
- Commitment to business – the metaphor of marriage helped mentees grasp the importance of dedication, patience, passion and consistent effort in their business
- Personal investment and growth – Humphrey emphasized the need to invest in self and the business through learnings, systems, time and effort; this fostered a sense of self-awareness, introspection and ongoing adaptation in their development as entrepreneurs
- Community, support and relationships – mentees gained perspective on their relationships and the importance of building a support network within their personal and professional lives

The full comments of mentees who gave feedback on Shivani's session can be found in the Appendix – 10. Group session feedback: marriage & goals.

LESSONS LEARNED

Throughout the programme, the team identified the following lessons learned:

Theme	Mitigation & recommendations going forward
Pernod Ricard people can make a difference in the lives of Township entrepreneurs by giving them a different perspective, insights, and levels of support. Mentors are starting to visit their mentees' business premises to understand what the environment and business context looks like, which enables them to give further informed support to the mentee and their business.	Encourage mentors to visit the business premises and locations of their mentees to get a full understanding of the demographics and space within which they operate. The launch and close out event of the 2022 programme was in Alex and were eye-opening for mentors – this connected the mentors and mentees immediately. The close-out event for the 2023 programme was a tour of Alex given by one of the mentees and their business associates. Consider having more regular events in Alex, including the group workshops.
Pernod Ricard staff are gaining exposure to valuable experiences and insights which they would otherwise not have	Share success stories and reports with wider Pernod Ricard team, for future mentors to join the programme and other offerings from the PRSA Foundation.
Mentee Mobilization – word of mouth was a successful mobilization approach as mentees from previous cohorts recommended the programme to the current cohort. This was also true for mentors within PRSA, who had heard of the programme from previous mentors.	Continue to recruit mentees from the AlexBiz network and ask previous mentees to identify new mentees to apply for the programme. Encourage former Pernod Ricard mentors to share their experience with departments to mobilize new mentors within the business.
Programme Growth – the energy and excitement from the pilot programme and subsequent years has made it easier to bring new mentors and mentees on board.	Continue to find new ways of encouraging people to participate in the programme, adapt the model from individual mentors to entire departments volunteering to mentor the group and individual mentees for a one-month period.
Leadership Involvement – the current programme is seeing high level PRSA Execs volunteering as mentors (Pamela, Ben and Sola), which role models leadership to the rest of the organisation, and speaks highly of the calibre of programme we have developed in our three year partnership.	Continue to share reports and stories of impact from the programme with the Pernod Ricard staff to communicate the benefits of volunteering as mentors in the programme and impacting the lives of young entrepreneurs, as well as developing their leadership skills. Ask Executive mentors from the current programme to spread the word.
Training and Launch – participants responded positively and with high engagement. All the mentors and mentees knew what to expect going into the programme, and this set a strong foundation for the partnerships.	Continue with training sessions during mobilization phase of the programme, providing field guides and workbooks; facilitate a goal setting session with the mentees to prepare them for their journey. Ensure an interactive launch that involves chemistry between participants.

Theme	Mitigation & recommendations going forward
Workshops – attendees showed high enthusiasm and engagement, though attendance was still below 50%, despite transport being provided and various communication methods to mentees.	Host workshops in Alex at the SafeHub to create more access to mentees to reach the sessions, and save Pernod Ricard the transport costs of the shuttle per month. Pernod Ricard mentors travel together to the SafeHub in Alex to save costs.
Mentees engaged in the WhatsApp group and group mentorship sessions and found benefit not only from the formal structure of the programme, but also from the community provided through Alex Biz and the Pernod Ricard mentorship opportunity.	Continue to engage with Thabiso Sebata, founder of Alex Biz to understand and report on the impacts of the mentorship programme on the value added to the growth of the mentees in the Alex Biz community. Continue to track conversations in the WhatsApp group to report on the support of the mentees to one another's businesses. Continue to record success stories after the group workshops.
Obtaining feedback: the WhatsApp groups proved to be a valuable source of feedback on the mentees (as well as a medium of collaboration amongst them) as are the in-person group sessions. However, Pernod Ricard staff are busy and their response rate to our surveys is low.	Continue with the WhatsApp group approach with the mentees and consider something similar for the mentors to foster a community of support and a collective experience. Consider online sessions where the mentors can join and complete their survey feedback, so that it is in their diaries and they commit to it.
Holding meetings at the Pernod Ricard premises, both the Woodmead office and the PRSA Foundation, has given the entrepreneurs a deeper insight into the corporate business environment and how they can engage in those spaces.	Encourage mentees to have meetings in corporate spaces or restaurants and public spaces they may not usually frequent to support them in expanding their exposure and comfort zone to various spaces. This will also expand their thinking and expose them to different businesses and business models.
Things change and we need to be adaptive and responsive to as things unfold – eg when a mentee withdraws at short notice	Ongoing Ops meetings and regular communication with the team between meetings. Neo, Claire and Thabiso have an ongoing WhatsApp group for administration and communication between the project team and Alex Biz. Thabiso has been very responsive and helpful when mentees withdraw and we need to replace them. He has a database of businesses where he looks to identify who would be suitable for the programme and connects us to them swiftly.
Mentees have had to withdraw from the programme due to lack of financial resources and needing to support themselves and their businesses more consistently.	Continue to support mentees, even if they are entering employment, but still wish to keep their business running in the background. Support the partnerships to understand how to navigate the changes in circumstances and encourage the mentee to seek guidance from their mentor as they go through changes.

APPENDIX

1. MENTORSHIP PARTNERSHIPS

MENTOR	MENTEE
Andile Yono	Sinethemba Dyasi
Angie Mabuza	Mantombi Dlala (Soweto)
Ben Ojwang	Leonard Mabula
Brantina Green	Tamara Moime
Brenton Forson	Jabulile Phiri
Cyril Goudon de Lalande	Rosina Makgoba
Edgar Dolamo	Dimakatso Vilankulu
Pamela Nkuna	Pogisho Matthews Mapheto
Gloria Kok	Nonhle Manzini
Humphrey Mvula	Maurice Modipa
Katlego Manchidi	Mogale Tleane
Kershnee Chetty	Mbalenhle Mwale
Linken Mashitisho	Hulisani Nethonzhe
Lungani Hlongwa	Aubrey Masuku
Mpho Kodisang	Mlaleli Godi
Nthulane Makgato	Lindi Mokhgabane
Sandy Muller	Gugu Xaba
Pravin Hardin	Sello Moloi
Gail Johns	Andile Butelezi (Kagiso)
Shivani Maharaj	Nick Dinhidza (Midrand)
Thirashan Naidoo	Thobani Buthelezi
Tiisetso Mthembu	Kgomotso Matukane
Vinay Morar	Ayanda Maredi
Sola Oke	Nomsa Ncube
Bobbie Crowther	Bridgette Mogoboya

2. LAUNCH EVENT PROGRAMME

Time	Activity	Facilitator	Notes
13:30	Pernod Ricard SA Welcome	Pamela	Context of the programme, incl. intent and aims
13:35	NMM Role and Support	Claire	Role of NMM and support offered
13:40	Group Check-in	Ros	
14:00	Session: What is mentorship, roles of the mentors and mentees	Ros	Exercise using sticky notes: -Step 1: On blue , write all the things you hope your mentor/ mentee will bring to the partnership -Step 2: On yellow , write all the things you believe your mentor/ mentee expects from you -Step 3: Match like for like
14:30	Debrief: Roles and expectations	Ros, Claire/ Neo	-Debrief the findings from the exercise, share roles of mentors/ mentees
14:50	Pair partnerships for first mentorship meeting	Ros, Claire, Neo	-Share inspirations, challenges, and discuss where and when you will meet -NMM team to go around and ask mentors to log onto platform with mentee and explore the page -Neo to complete any outstanding registrations
15:20	Close and Thanks	All	

3. MENTEE GOALS AND PROGRESS TOWARDS ACHIEVING THEM

These are the goals that the mentees and mentors agreed on at the beginning of the programme.

What goals have you set with your mentor?	How are you planning to achieve these goals?
Target goals and recording of transactions	But doing my small daily task to put on record each and every transaction made, as well as pushing hard on sales and marketing to reaching my target for this month
To sign of all agreements our business is pursuing	Am reading various business management books particularly focusing on financial management
Building a strong online presence	We still planning the next meeting where we going to set the foundation of how we are going to achieve these goals
To have more social media presence	To be more confident and believe that I can achieve the goals I have set
Getting my accreditation	Prioritising my goals for least to most important and looking into different quotes I can get for getting my accreditation
To get an IP Protection for my company,	With the IP Protection we already taking with the Legal Team for a Pro-bono case and with getting our company out there we have the strategic document which outlines our niche
Overall plan. To get new clients. To get my financials right. To get new branding for marketing and advertising. To get my own production machines .	Slowly building, for marketing and machines I'm looking at getting funding , which I have already started to apply with few entities. To try ans save for some of the things like getting someone to run our administration and social media platforms.
Getting Compliance for the Business to be Legit	Following the right path to acquire the licence
So far, I'm satisfied with the guidance and the insight that my mentor has provided , my goal looking forward is to continue learning about the strategic decision -	Is to clarify my rental goals, prepare the room, set competitive pricing, advertise effectively, screen tenants carefully, draft

What goals have you set with your mentor? making and leadership in business. I'd also like to work with my mentor to refine my long term career plan and explore opportunities for growth, developing business ideas or improving operational efficiency	How are you planning to achieve these goals? a lease or agreement and plan for ongoing management
We are currently on bigger goal of getting me certified.	Either through education funding or through me getting a full time job
To Assist with Clients Presentation and Develop Sales Pitch	We agree that he will make himself available for my meeting with clients, I also like to continue to share lists of clients' expectations
With my mentor, I've set goals focused on strengthening my business foundation. We're working on optimizing costs while refining our pricing strategy to attract more customers. Additionally, we're rebranding by updating visuals to better align with our market. A key part of our approach is testing and adjusting based on early results, ensuring that our decisions drive growth and improve profitability.	To achieve these goals, I'm taking a structured approach. For cost optimization, I'm reviewing expenses, adjusting pricing, and implementing discounts and bundle deals to attract more customers. On the rebranding side, I'm handling the visual updates in-house to ensure consistency and cost-effectiveness. I'm also tracking key metrics like sales growth, customer acquisition, and profit margins, making adjustments based on early results to refine our strategy and maximize impact.
To help me meet his colleague that works at the marketing Department	To also make me meet his Lawyer colleague to discuss about Intellectual Property, to meet with them in our next In-person meeting

Mentee comments after three months

- We jointly developed a schedule with Lunga, he gives me tasks and I need to deliver on them backed up by evidence, on how they were achieved.
- Katlego gives me homework, like now next time we meet I need to present the business' financials to her and then we find a way to improve how I take care of that part of the business. We measure from the tasks we have on hand.
- I use notes, Pernod Ricard gave us a notebook at the beginning of the programme.
- Bobbie encouraged me to have notes every time we meet so I do write down and tick off what has been accomplished.
- I made my goals very clear at the beginning of our partnership with Linken and we go through them in every meeting we have with him.
- I attend our meetings with my notebook and evaluate my list; Vinay gives me homework

for every goal I have on my list.

- Right now I have a spreadsheet where I wrote everything and I am trying to evaluate every two weeks where we are with Pamela.
- Ben is a very organised gentleman and that is how we started off our partnership, he gives me homework and I give him feedback and re-evaluate, then correct where needed.
- On our bi-weekly meetings, we start with looking at previous goals set and we check whether they have been met or extra time is required. Also with certain tasks i.e. Business Profile writing, I send in advance and we discuss what changes need to be made or additions.
- We keep notes with Tiisetso and she helps me tick off tasks that are completed.

4. MENTOR COMMENT ON PROGRESS TOWARDS ACHIEVING THE GOALS

Mentor comment after one month

- The goal is to get the business back on its feet and create a Kasi experience.
- Consistent focus on future planning, on establishing his goals and working backwards to understand what he needs to do in order to achieve them.
- To have finalized a business plan for any interested investors. To calculate her net profits on all her products to determine where her focus should be. Free up time to have some personal time. This means running her days efficiently.
- To have finalized a business plan for any interested investors. To calculate her net profits on all her products to determine where her focus should be. Free up time to have some personal time. This means running her days efficiently.
- To ensure that Hulisani complies with liquor board requirement & the law, attracts partnerships with alcohol companies in the country.
- My mentee is expected to demonstrate growth in key competencies, increased confidence, and clear progress toward their personal and professional development goals.
- Secure income to purchase better equipment.
- To achieve a sustainable profit within his business.

Mentor comment after three months

- 1. Opening a business bank account 2. Sustained a profit however there is still a lot that needs to be done.
- He was very communicative on WhatsApp and we met four times in person, which helped with our partnership experience. We managed to get support from National Innovation committee, Leonard got R 1.5 million grant so he really did an amazing job.
- I think she has made some good progress; her way of thinking has improved; she is very busy and sometimes she finds it difficult to order her day and run it financially efficiently as possible. I have tried to instill some good practices with her so hopefully that worked.
- Started branding himself and his company much more on various free platforms example whatsapp, fb marketplace, tik tok etc
 - Prioritised saving money
 - Applied for loans and machinery
 - Researched about options for government fundings are available
 - He employed one full time employee
 - Commission structure implemented
 - Introduced him to Chief Financial Officer at Pernod Ricard
- I think he has made reasonable progress; his thought process is in the right direction. He just needs to implement what we have discussed. Part of his goals was working on to delegate, he is seeing that now happening in his business because they are getting more projects.
- She has made some progress; however this needs a bit of context because the progress was limited. She owns a tavern but she did not have a liquor licence so when I started with her, I was asking about what is the business like, how much is she making on a daily and she gave me those figures. Before Pernod Ricard, I was working for another alcohol company and I offered to hook her up with people that can at least revamp your place and I also asked about the compliance issues like liquor licence number etc. She did not have and she is in the process of getting it. Luckily, I know one of the guys who are on the liquor board to find out the progress on her application and they said there are some

documents that are missing. I informed her about the documentation and she went to Liquor board in Braamfontein to find out what the issue is. I think it is worth mentioning that this whole thing of issuing liquor licences has a lot of corruption in it; that is why I said let's use the people that I know. We later found out that there was an issue with the title deed at her grandmother's place. It is thing of other houses were issued and some were not so she had to go to the local council around to find out what is holding up the process of the deed and they said they cannot issue the licence without the title deed. That is what has held up our progress because they told her she needs to go back to housing and restart the whole process, which could take some time. That is why I am saying her progress is limited, however it is totally out of her control.

- So the first goal was around marketing the business, in terms of support and guidance I have provided he actioned it and now I guess the next thing is reviewing from that, what is the uptake from a clientele perspective.
- He managed to get a job, which is one of the things we discussed because in order to be able to successfully run their company and have it registered, you need to be certified by the board of plumbers so in order to get that certification, you need to spend some time with a plumbing so I proposed a job at a plumbing rather than going to school because of financial reasons. I would say that there is quite a lot of progress at the end of the day, he still has his business but he is on his way to get certified through the company that he is working for, which is beneficial to his company.
- She did tell me she was scared to step away from the programme, she was scared that you guys would have seen it as a waste like she wasting your time. I told her it is not about that it was a waste of time; it is what you got out of it to ensure that the business can be a success in the future. She was worried that if she had to come back to the programme, maybe she would not be accepted. Being an entrepreneur, there will be obstacles and setbacks and I told her to see this as a setback, not as a "I wasted people's time and they would not even want to consider me again" kind of thing. It is just that at this time of the moment she has got to live and that is high up on her priorities currently

5. GROUP SESSION FEEDBACK: OVERALL

- They have been very helpful and not only the sessions, Lunga too has been very present, even went to an extent of joining my client and I at some point. They have been amazing and I think I have attended three so far and all the information shared with us impacts business system, especially with attracting clients and with regards to the HR session, it opened my eyes to see the importance of extra assistance to recruit and grow the business. thank you for the support and treatment.
- Very helpful for the business and growth as an entrepreneur.
- They have helped me a lot because now I know how to roll my payroll, I can handle my finances better given that Katlego is finance focused. When you decide to join the programme, you do not think about many layers that a business has and these sessions show us these layers I am talking about.
- They have been very helpful because I have a lot going on in the business now, I am in Durban as we speak for a tender proposal. I have a deeper understanding of the business now from the topics discussed at the sessions.
- The session was very eye-opening; I was not aware that HR is such a layered department. Now I know more about resolving conflicts in a business and who is the right person to handle these kinds of matters. I think what I took away with me most is the process of

recruiting for the business.

- The sessions have been an important component to this programme; they give us insight of what it entails to run a business and the mentors are very open with us during these sessions
- The session was a high level presentation, felt like I was schooled on a career we usually take for granted and I saw its importance. Right recruitment will take a business far, following the processes in HR makes it easy for everyone involved in a business and HR itself has a lot of departments that i was not aware of. The sessions are very helpful.
- What I can say is that it is kind of getting there, still premature I think and I am only saying this because I have not seen the results yet.
- I think I have only attended the first one, thereafter we got a little busy in the business but I thoroughly enjoyed Ruvi's session. Revenue management is as important as the topics that followed for a business so I found it very helpful for me personally and the growth of our business.
- Group sessions are extremely helpful cause apart from learning from the mentors, you also learn from the other mentees and the progress they are making within their businesses. This also pushes one to invest more time and differentiate themselves and their business.
- I found the first one very informative and insightful, apologies I could not attend the two that followed. Ruvi really articulated the revenue management session really well and it is all up to us to implement the discussions in our businesses.
- I attended the first two and the topics discussed are needed for an effective and sustainable business, so I believe they will be very helpful for my business.
- The first one was helpful and it was also good to hear from the other entrepreneurs how they run their business and what they know about mentorship.
- The two sessions I have attended have been helpful for the business, the engagement with the mentors have made it easy for me to consume.

6. GROUP SESSION FEEDBACK: REVENUE MANAGEMENT

- Today's session on revenue management was relatable and I found it to be highly informative and insightful. Ruvy provided a comprehensive overview of the key factors to consider when managing revenue for a business. One of the most valuable takeaways from the session was the importance of considering multiple factors when pricing and preparing services. I realised that I had previously overlooked several crucial aspects, including value-based pricing strategy, and package deals. The session highlighted the need to take a more holistic approach to revenue management, considering factors such as production costs, your time, target audience, and market competition. Another key insight from the session was the importance of tracking performance of your business, such as revenue growth. This data will enable me to make informed decisions about my business and identify areas for improvement. For future sessions, I would appreciate it if the facilitator could provide more examples of service-based businesses, rather than focusing solely on product-based businesses. This would help me better understand how to apply the revenue management principles to my own business. Overall, I found the session to be highly informative and engaging. The facilitator's expertise and insights have given me a newfound understanding of revenue management and its importance in business. I look forward to applying these principles to my own business and exploring

new revenue streams.

- Let me start by saying, Thanks to Pernod Ricard and our host yesterday, Rudy, on behalf of us as mentees for this mentorship opportunity. We learnt about the five pillars, which are Pricing, Offerings, Product/Mixing, promotion and Discounts. My take on the whole presentation is brief, basically every cent counts, the money coming in and the money going out, should always be accounted for, no matter how little it may be, this in turn helps one to understand whether they making it in their business or are they fumbling. If you are able to determine this through your entire business revenue then you will be able to improve, innovative and eventually establish your brand as one of the strong brands around all your competitors in your own different business industry. The session also gave insight on how important it is to put more value on your products or services. Nonetheless thanks to everyone and to Claire, Neo and Rudy. We come from different backgrounds and that alone sets all of us apart however right now, we are one thing because we are in the same culture, which is future business owners and eventually employers.

7. GROUP SESSION FEEDBACK: PROCUREMENT

- Gaining knowledge about the necessary compliance documents allowed me to understand their role in creating effective contracts and successful business transactions. Overall, this experience was invaluable and has enhanced my understanding of procurement significantly. I am now more aware of how each document fits into the larger procurement puzzle, contributing to overall business success. Overall, the experience was incredible.
- Today was insightful very important in understanding how procurement is vital in any part of a business with protocols that safeguard both the company and 3rd parties. For me this ties in to next month's topic HR and payroll how you may ask, getting the right people to do the job in my case I'm looking to employ staff (waiters etc) and guidelines such as these assistant in picking suitable candidates for the job spec. Value for your buck one of the reasons we took so long in finalising construction at Stoep was we went for who could accommodate our budget and that that meant more headaches and chest pains, one contractor after another who identified and correct the previous contractors mistakes etc it was a nightmare. Also for supply purposes it is vital to have the right etiquette and not behave like we are expecting to give out "cool drinks " like public sector compliance is everything.
- Today's session on procurement was something new to me honestly. I had a little knowledge about procurement, and I couldn't even explain what it meant. However, after today's session, I have a much clearer understanding of the concept and its application in business. Key Takeaways:
 1. Procurement principles can apply to both product-based and service-based industries.
 2. I learned the importance of excluding VAT when quoting.
 3. The training provided valuable insights into essential business concepts.I initially found it challenging to relate the training to my own professional context, but the trainer clarified that the concepts can be applied to various industries. I'm grateful for the new knowledge and understanding I gained today, and I'm confident it will be helpful for my future work.
- Today session was fruitful for me, I have learned something new, now I'm aware that
 - Vat must be excluded when quoting
 - the importance of compliance documents and non-disclosure, honesty is very important

on contracts.

- I wanted to express my gratitude to our host for yesterday's session my key take away is that expertise and compliance are crucial for success as a vendor it is essential to meet the requirements terms, as failure to do so you can result to cancellation and loss of opportunity and I learned about the different types of vendors be it service, product and hybrid vendors additionally it is importance to consider factors such as pricing and cost when selecting a vendor thank you.

8. GROUP SESSION FEEDBACK: HR & PAYROLL

- I really enjoyed this session and it was such an eye opener and a bit of a reflection moment. My take from this session is that treating your employees well and investing in them helps build your brand and them in the process. I hope when our companies are big and flourishing, we may remember these small things that help build the character, value and culture of the company.
- Today's payroll and HR training session with Sandy was really helpful. Sandy explained complex payroll processes in a way that was easy to understand. Some of the content might be more suited for big companies, but I think we can still apply some of the ideas to our own small business. We also got to get some baked cookies from Inqaku - they were delicious! Thank you so much for that. I enjoyed how everyone participated and engaged with the training. Sandy was enthusiastic and knowledgeable, which made the session fun and interactive. Overall, I'd recommend Sandy's payroll and HR training to anyone who wants to learn more about payroll. Thanks, Sandy, for a great learning experience!

9. GROUP SESSION FEEDBACK: PROBLEM SOLVING & VALUE CHAIN MAPPING

- Good evening, fam'. I believe everyone here today found the session to be truly inspiring. The ideas we discussed sparking creativity and innovation in how we handle problems. Today, I felt a sense of unity as we all learned together. Each topic was engaging and pushed us to think beyond our usual boundaries. Overall, today's session helped us feel prepared for future challenges in life & in business.
- Thank you for part one, Problem Solving and value streaming has helped me incorporate all previous sessions, personifying business and not just looking at it as just another income stream. The first session has helped tremendously Why- Why- Why-Why-Why it's all connected and we have to ask the difficult questions no one wants to ask especially if you want to prosper🙏

10. GROUP SESSION FEEDBACK: MARRIAGE & GOALS

- I learnt about Failure because if you don't try u already failed but if u try and fail U'll know the next step you don't have to figure things out but go to the next step.
- I learnt that you should take risks because if you tried your best you would fail. Setting Goals is important you know where you are going n mostly important ur disires how bad

you want it. N I learnt that investing in ur self is important because it's the easiest way to attract anything u want.

- The session was more emotional realizing the commitment I've made with the business that I own. Without realizing that I put more time, effort and money into it. To sit and introspect beyond failure, to say, really, I'm in the right path - is this what I want to do? It was very emotional because you lose contact with your closest family, your friends, the community members, based on this marriage that one is on. It was an eye opener to review my goals, my visions, with all the tools that you help us. What makes me excited is that I'm currently putting all the systems in place. Thank you very much.
- A huge thank you to Humphrey and Lance on today's session. Humphrey brought it back home with his presentation as it was relatable, kasi chic, thought provoking, personal, inspirational and importantly highly spiritual 🙏 high key enjoyed it! I learned that marriage and business have a lot in common... In order to run an effective business one needs to have a pathway in the form of goalsetting & vision, be committed, patient, passionate, have a community and take accountability for all the trials and tribulations that we may face.

1. Nothing beautiful comes from working in silos and ignoring problems.

2. Be independent but DO NOT BE AFRAID TO ASK FOR HELP, you are not an octopus afterall!

3. If the spark runs out, it doesn't mean it's the end of the road or your dream.

4. Don't burn your bridges. If the need arises, exit elegantly.

5. Trap yourself by investing in yourself and your business in the form of putting in the hours so that it's not easy to quit.

As the late Aaliyah once sang, if at first you don't succeed, dust yourself up and try again! Failure is part of the process :-)

Pernod Ricard Mentorship Group 2025 Cohort 3 —

Greater & Stronger Together 🙏🙏

- I have learned that business is the same as marriage you have to be committed. You should take risks and setting goals very important.
- Hi today's workshop thought me to marry my business with real commitment today was amazing the key lessons I took are * create business vows *stay focused and avoid comparison. *Refill the cup. *Don't burn bridges *know myself and my business. *Take responsibility *network ,research and grow. * Appreciate what I have *do things differently * have a clear vision * choose my circle wisely stay blessed everyone Amen

